Table 1 PosterBench Score and dimension scores for the PosterBench Main Track on the 100-paper evaluation set. Systems are grouped by their primary design mechanism. "—" denotes a layer that a system does not use.

System	Design Harness	Coding Agent	Model	Score	Faith.	Cover.	Density	Vis. Ev.	Layout	Read.	Aesth.
Design Agent											
AutoDesign	**DesignHarness**	Claude Code	Claude 4.8	78.32	9.35	9.40	8.41	5.97	8.55	8.17	5.59
AutoDesign	**DesignHarness**	Codex	GPT 5.5	77.97	9.57	9.35	8.63	5.47	7.75	8.08	7.16
Claude Design	Claude Design	Claude Code	Claude 4.8	70.87	9.22	9.90	6.48	7.62	8.08	5.96	7.36
OpenDesign	OpenDesign	Claude Code	Claude 4.8	69.45	9.17	9.37	7.51	6.12	7.08	6.19	7.01
OpenDesign	OpenDesign	Codex	GPT 5.5	62.17	9.24	8.49	6.91	5.05	7.24	5.76	6.00
Coding Agent											
Codex	—	Codex	GPT 5.5	73.37	9.64	9.71	7.69	7.43	8.03	6.08	6.60
Claude Code	—	Claude Code	Claude 4.8	70.01	9.25	9.88	5.71	7.01	9.46	6.68	6.53
Doubao	—	Claude Code	Seed 2.1	61.14	8.93	8.96	5.95	5.97	6.51	5.63	4.61
GLM	—	Claude Code	GLM 5.2	52.22	8.60	7.44	5.23	5.29	7.03	4.90	5.15
Kimi	—	Claude Code	Kimi K2.7	51.46	8.33	7.15	4.72	5.62	7.26	4.93	4.81
DeepSeek	—	Claude Code	DeepSeekV4-Pro	46.01	8.23	6.68	4.10	3.82	6.95	4.41	3.38
Human-Crafted Workflow											
PosterGen	—	—	Claude 4.8	56.71	8.84	8.25	4.31	5.62	8.61	5.36	5.28
Any2Poster	—	—	Claude 4.8	49.09	8.26	5.44	4.18	3.65	9.59	4.47	3.10
Paper2Poster	—	—	Claude 4.8	44.61	6.35	2.35	8.36	2.16	3.69	4.87	1.69

Table 2 PosterBench Score and dimension scores for the PosterBench-mini Main Track on the original 10-paper subset.

System	Design Harness	Coding Agent	Model	Score	Faith.	Cover.	Density	Vis. Ev.	Layout	Read.	Aesth.
Design Agent											
AutoDesign	**DesignHarness**	Codex	GPT 5.5	**81.46**	9.88	9.90	8.64	6.20	8.01	7.96	7.45
AutoDesign	**DesignHarness**	Claude Code	Claude 4.8	**74.56**	9.28	8.80	8.15	5.00	9.00	7.86	6.75
OpenDesign	OpenDesign	Claude Code	Claude 4.8	70.36	9.10	9.00	7.39	6.15	7.13	6.38	7.31
Claude Design	Claude Design	Claude Code	Claude 4.8	66.83	8.95	10.00	5.24	7.90	8.54	6.09	6.77
OpenDesign	OpenDesign	Codex	GPT 5.5	60.58	9.03	9.20	6.13	5.45	7.68	5.75	5.75
Coding Agent											
Codex	—	Codex	GPT 5.5	75.87	9.47	9.40	7.88	7.55	8.44	6.00	7.00
Claude Code	—	Claude Code	Claude 4.8	69.55	9.19	10.00	5.21	7.50	9.76	6.90	6.40
Kimi	—	Claude Code	Kimi K2.7	57.20	8.20	8.20	4.91	6.40	7.91	5.60	5.95
Doubao	—	Claude Code	Seed 2.1	54.01	7.99	8.20	6.30	5.55	6.01	5.52	6.15
GLM	—	Claude Code	GLM5.2	50.32	8.83	7.80	3.79	3.85	8.21	5.11	5.45
DeepSeek	—	Claude Code	DeepSeekV4-Pro	34.73	8.08	7.90	2.94	3.33	5.98	3.71	5.05
Human-Crafted Workflow											
PosterGen	—	—	Claude 4.8	51.82	8.95	9.33	3.39	6.67	7.67	4.96	5.50
Any2Poster	—	—	Claude 4.8	46.88	8.09	4.90	3.69	3.65	9.55	4.40	3.20
Paper2Poster	—	—	Claude 4.8	42.06	6.16	2.10	8.25	2.30	2.76	4.82	1.80

harness improves the PosterBench Score by 5.01–19.56 points. Under the native Codex–GPT-5.5 configuration, it raises the score from 75.87 to 81.46 (+5.59); with Claude Code and Kimi K2.7, it rises from 57.20 to 70.12 (+12.92). The largest gain is 19.56 points for DeepSeek V4 Pro with Claude Code. These improvements span multiple model–code-agent pairs. MLLMs have an additional repair signal unavailable to text-only LLMs: at each attempt, the rendered preview from the preceding attempt is supplied as visual context for the next repair. This lets the model inspect the artifact it is editing and localize layout, clipping, or visual-evidence failures that are not fully captured by textual diagnostics alone.

5.2.2 Cost–Performance Trade-off

Figure 8 compares PosterBench Score with a normalized designer-only API cost proxy across the seven AutoDesign model configurations on PosterBench-mini, the fixed 10-paper subset. The observed Pareto frontier runs from LongCat-2.0[2] (55.13 at $0.27 per poster), through Doubao Seed 2.1 Pro (71.83 at $2.75) and Claude 4.8 (74.56 at $7.63), to GPT-5.5 (81.46 at $10.02). Doubao reaches 88% of the GPT-5.5 score at 27% of its cost, while GPT-5.5 provides the highest absolute performance.

[2]The reported cost reflects LongCat-2.0's pricing policy at evaluation time: cached context incurs no charge on a cache hit.